Apex Systems

Engineering-led, security-first delivery

Response to RFP-2026-017: Cloud Procurement & Supplier Management Platform for Meridian Manufacturing Ltd. FICTIONAL document for training use.

1. Executive Summary and Understanding of the Requirement

Apex Systems understands that Meridian Manufacturing needs one platform to manage sourcing events, supplier onboarding, contracts and spend analytics across 14 plants, replacing three disconnected tools.

We propose a cloud-native platform built on a microservice architecture with a documented REST and event API, deployed on Kubernetes across two availability zones. Our design targets 99.95% availability and has been load tested to 5,000 concurrent users, five times Meridian's projected peak.

2. Proposed Solution and Approach

Architecture. Stateless microservices behind an API gateway, PostgreSQL with synchronous replication, and a message bus for asynchronous workflows. Horizontal autoscaling is configured for the sourcing, supplier-portal and analytics services independently.

Integrations. Certified connectors for SAP S/4HANA and Microsoft Dynamics 365, SSO through SAML 2.0 and OpenID Connect, and a bulk-import API for the legacy supplier master. Integration specifications are delivered in week 3 and tested in a dedicated sandbox before each release.

Scalability. Capacity tests show linear scaling to 20 million line items with p95 page response under 1.2 seconds.

3. Timeline, Team and Milestones

Delivery runs 9 months in four phases. Our delivery team is 11 people: a project manager, two architects, five engineers, a QA lead, a security engineer and a change-management consultant.

Milestone	Month	Deliverable
Design sign-off	2	Architecture and integration specifications
Core platform release	5	Sourcing, supplier portal, contracts
Integration complete	7	SAP and Dynamics connectors in production-like test
Go-live	9	Phased rollout to 14 plants

4. Price and Assumptions

Item	Cost (USD)
Licence, years 1-3	210,000
Implementation services	180,000
Integration and migration	60,000
Training	30,000
Total (3 years)	480,000

Assumptions: Fixed price for the scope above. Excludes travel, third-party licences and changes after design sign-off, which are charged at USD 1,100 per day.

5. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

Apex holds ISO 27001 and SOC 2 Type II certifications (reports available under NDA). Data is encrypted at rest with AES-256 and in transit with TLS 1.3, with customer-managed keys optional.

Role-based access control, mandatory MFA, immutable audit logs retained 7 years, annual third-party penetration tests and a GDPR-aligned data processing agreement with EU data residency.

Key risks. Integration with the legacy ERP is the main technical risk; mitigated by an early proof-of-concept. A 9-month schedule leaves limited room for scope growth.

6. Support Model, Experience and References

Business-hours support (08:00-18:00 CET) is included; 24x7 support is available at an extra USD 40,000 a year. Incident response targets are 4 hours for severity 1.

Apex has delivered 6 comparable procurement platforms over 8 years. References are available on request.